

Skills

Measuring Oxygen Saturation with Pulse Oximetry

Checklist

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S = Satisfactory U = Unsatisfactory NP = Not Performed

Step	S	U	NP	Comments
Verified health care provider's orders.	☐	☐	☐	
Gathered necessary equipment and supplies.	☐	☐	☐	
Provided for the patient's privacy and performed hand hygiene. Donned appropriate personal protective equipment (PPE) based on the patient's need for isolation precautions or risk of exposure to bodily fluids.	☐	☐	☐	
Introduced self to patient and family, identified patient using two identifiers, compared identifiers with information on patient's ID bracelet.	☐	☐	☐	
Explained the procedure to the patient and ensured that he or she agreed to treatment.	☐	☐	☐	
Ensured intervention was appropriate, cleansed stethoscope.	☐	☐	☐	
Selected appropriate site for sensor placement and prepared site, if necessary.	☐	☐	☐	
Assessed capillary refill, selected alternative site when necessary.	☐	☐	☐	
Positioned patient comfortably, instructed patient to breathe normally.	☐	☐	☐	
Attached sensor to monitoring site, reassured patient that clip-on probe would not hurt.	☐	☐	☐	
Turned on oximeter.	☐	☐	☐	
Observed pulse/waveform intensity display, listened for beep, correlated oximeter pulse rate with patient's radial pulse, left sensor in place appropriate length of time, read the SpO ₂ , discussed findings with patient.	☐	☐	☐	

When monitoring continuously, determined limits for SpO₂ and pulse rate, verified alarms were preset and on, assessed skin integrity at appropriate intervals.

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When monitoring intermittently, removed probe, turned oximeter power off, cleaned probe and stored sensor in appropriate location.

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Performed hand hygiene.

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Compared SpO₂ with patient's previous baseline and acceptable range.

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Recorded SpO₂ in appropriate log, indicated type and amount of oxygen therapy used by patient during assessment, recorded signs of alteration in oxygen saturation, reported abnormal findings to health care provider, compared results with patient's baseline or previous values.

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Learner: _____
Evaluator: _____
Date: _____

Signature: _____
Signature: _____